

Statement of Need
for
12th Aircraft Maintenance Squadron's T-38
Engine Intake Plug and Exhaust Cover Fabrication

25 March 2026

1. This memorandum provides the Statement of Need (SOW) for the procurement of engine intake plugs and exhaust covers for eighty (80) T-38 Talon aircraft assigned to the 435th Flying Training Squadron.
2. The 435th FTS operates with eighty T-38 aircraft in support of pilot training operations. When parked on the flightline, aircraft engines are exposed to environmental hazards including foreign object debris (FOD), precipitation, dust, wildlife intrusion, and high winds. Engine intake plugs and exhaust covers are required to mitigate FOD risk, preserve engine integrity, and maintain aircraft readiness. Additionally, the former 560th Flying Training Squadron has been redesignated as the 435th Flying Squadron. Existing engine covers display outdated unit identifiers. New covers bearing the official 435th FTS insignia are required to ensure proper unit identification and heritage representation.
3. The contractor shall provide all labor, materials, equipment, and quality control necessary to manufacture and deliver engine intake plugs and exhaust covers for eighty (80) T-38 aircraft. Each aircraft requires:
 - Two (2) intake plugs
 - One (1) exhaust coverTotal Required:
 - One-hundred and sixty (160) intake plugs
 - Eighty (80) exhaust covers
 - Total: 240 covers
4. Requirements.
 - General Specifications. All covers shall:
 - Be specifically designed and properly fitted for T-38 engine intake and exhaust configurations.
 - Be constructed of durable, weather-resistant, UV-resistant, and moisture-resistant vinyl suitable for continuous outdoor flightline exposure and filled with a block of sculpted urethane foam.
 - Be black in color.
 - Include integrated "Remove Before Flight" streamers meeting aviation safety visibility standards.
 - Exhaust covers shall include securing straps or retention systems to prevent dislodgment during high-wind conditions.
 - Plugs and covers shall be able to withstand temperatures up to 300 degrees Fahrenheit.
 - Be lightweight and installable/removable by a single maintainer.
 - Prevent intrusion of dust, sand, moisture, birds, and other foreign objects.

- Include two-year replacement warranty.
 - Markings and Insignia. Each cover shall:
 - Display the official 435th Flying Squadron insignia (Government Furnished Information).
 - Include a designated area for identification marking.
 - Utilize durable, fade-resistant printing or embroidery methods.
 - Resist peeling, cracking, or fading under prolonged UV exposure.
- 5. Delivery Requirements.
 - Delivery Location: 11090 5th St East Hanger 3, JBSA Randolph TX 78150
 - Delivery Timeline: Within 90 days of contract award (or as negotiated).
 - Items shall be packaged to prevent shipping damage.
 - Contractor shall coordinate delivery with the Government Point of Contact (POC).
- 6. Quality Assurance and Acceptance.
 - All items must meet applicable aerospace ground support durability standards.
 - The Government will inspect items upon delivery for proper fit, material integrity, and insignia accuracy.
 - Defective or non-conforming items shall be replaced at no additional cost to the Government.
- 7. Performance shall commence upon contract award and conclude upon delivery and Government acceptance of all required items.
- 8. Government Furnished Information (GFI).
 - Official 435th FTS insignia artwork
 - Aircraft marking specifications
 - Government POC information